AF6.4 · Agents can no longer be given a human who does not exist

Agent Factory · measured 15 October 2026 · shipped in #3117 · one page

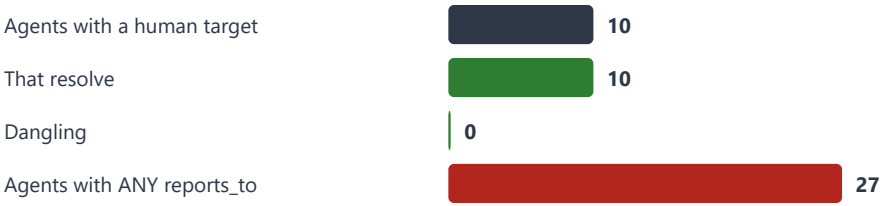
TAKEAWAY

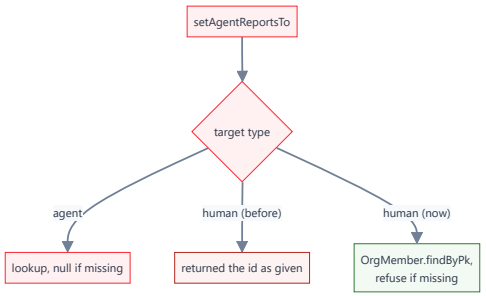
This closes a LATENT hole and repairs no existing damage. All 10 human targets resolve; zero dangle.

What was found

1. **The asymmetry was the bug.** An `agent` target was validated with a real lookup and returned null when dangling. A `human` target was RETURNED AS GIVEN with no lookup, so the guard rejected only an empty string.
2. **Fixed on the write path, deliberately NOT in the resolver.** The resolver is also the read path for the live ticket-creation gate; a lookup there would start refusing ticket creation for any agent whose chain already ends at a missing human. A test asserts the resolver stays clean.
3. **Said plainly because the alternative would be a claim about rows that do not exist.** "We fixed the dangling reports_to" would be false. Nothing was dangling.

Measured





The same function validated one branch and trusted the other.

What this does NOT establish

- THE BIGGER FINDING IS NOT FIXED. 165 enabled agents have no reports_to at all; 126 of them have executed, 3,233,076 runs between them, led by visitor_tracker at 1,201,301. Only 27 of 257 agents have any reports_to. Ticketed as AF6.6.

Built from the same data module as the AF6.4 document, so a number here cannot drift from a number there. Filed in 06 - Owner Decisions and Blockers.